Step 3 - For security purposes, create credentials file in your home directory. Hidden files can be created using (.)

nano ~/ .smbcredentials

(nano is one of the popular text editor provided along with Ubuntu)

You can update the username and password in the file -

username=<any username>

password=<any password>

Step 4 - To automount the directory, edit the /etc/fstab file using nano utility.

sudo nano /etc/fstab

Add the below mentioned line at end of the file as follows. Values to be updated as per your environment..

//192.168.1.12/share/media/share cifs credentials=/home/user/.smbcredentials,users,rw,iocharset=utf8,sec=ntlm 0 0

Now you can easily execute Windows programs and access files across operating systems.

Chapter 3: Flavours of other Desktop Environments

There are a plethora of desktop environments out there waiting to be explored. Make your choice.

Desktop environment is a collection of programs running at the top of an operating system. It shares the graphical user interface and comprises of icons, folders, desktop widgets, screensavers, wallpapers, etc. It helps users to easily perform administrative tasks operations on their computer resources without having to rely on commands to do the same. However, the command-line interface helps utilise features of the operating system to the micro level, which otherwise is not possible with the GUI.

When it comes to desktop environment preferences, different users will have different choices. Ease of customisation would be the most common factor that would matter to the users. There are various desktop environments based on Linux. Some of them are Cinnamon, Budgie, KDE Plasma, XfCE, Gnome, Mate, Ambient, Deepin DE, CDE, Elokab, EDE, Enlightenment, etc. A few of the popular ones are briefly discussed below.

KDE Plasma

KDE Plasma has a collection of applications and ease of customisation is its USP. It is highly flexible as well. Frequent updates make it more dynamic